



# *Small Hours*

TWELVE SHORT POEMS



## *Kettle*

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Before the house is quite awake  
the kettle clears its throat,  
and everything I meant to say  
turns into steam and floats.

## *Lighthouse*

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All night it says one word  
to ships it will not meet:  
here, here, here—  
as if that were enough to keep.

## *Inventory*

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One cup, one chair, one window,  
one slow and patient plant.

I count them like a sleepless child  
who counts what she still can't.

## *Snow*

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The snow came down to listen.  
It settled on the street  
and held its breath so long that  
the town forgot its feet.



## *Train*

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A train goes by at two a.m.  
with no one, I suppose, aboard—  
just lit-up windows, carrying  
the dark from town to town, toward.

## *Library*

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The books are mostly sleeping.

A few are reading me.

I turn a page, and somewhere

a sentence turns to see.

## *Small Hours*

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These are the hours too small for clocks,  
the ones you hold, not keep:  
the space between a thought and word,  
the hallway into sleep.

## *Letter*

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I wrote to you and didn't send it.  
It waits inside a drawer,  
where unsent letters learn the things  
that letters are for.



## *Rain on a Skylight*

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Someone is typing on the roof  
in a language made of glass.  
I cannot read a word of it.  
I let the paragraphs pass.

## *Moth*

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The moth is in love with the lamp  
the way I am with June:  
foolishly, completely,  
and far too soon.

## *Map*

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My grandfather drew islands  
no bigger than a shoe.  
He said the smallest places  
are where the sea speaks true.

## *Morning*

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And then the light comes, ordinary,  
and pours itself like tea.  
The night puts down what it was holding.  
So, finally, do we.



*Read slowly. It's late.*